

Summary

As you just learned, we can use recursion to not only solve mazes (by traversing them as tree data structures) but also generate them using the recursive backtracker algorithm. The algorithm “carves out” hallways in the maze, backtracking to earlier points when it encounters a dead end. Once the algorithm is forced to backtrack to the starting point, the maze is completely generated.

We can represent a well-connected maze with no loops as a DAG—that is, a tree data structure. The recursive backtracker algorithm makes use of the idea that recursive algorithms are well suited to problems involving tree-like data structures and backtracking.